
COMPREHENSIVE LIST OF ALL LEGISLATION (1947-1970)
APPLICABLE TO EAST PAKISTAN / PRESENT-DAY BANGLADESH

PRIMARY LEGISLATION: Acts, Ordinances, Orders, Martial Law Orders,
Constitutional Instruments

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NOTE: This covers PARENT/ENABLING legislation (Acts, Ordinances, Orders),
not subordinate/delegated legislation (rules, regulations, by-laws),
which is covered separately in the Research document.

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PART I: CONSTITUTIONAL INSTRUMENTS AND ADAPTATION ORDERS

Ref	Title	Year	Status in BD
C-01	Indian Independence Act, 1947 (10 & 11 Geo. 6 c. 30, UK Parliament) Subject: Partition of British India, creation of Pakistan and India as independent dominions Significance: Foundation of Pakistan's legal existence; Section 18 ensured legal continuity	1947	Historical
C-02	Pakistan (Provisional Constitution) Order, 1947 Authority: Governor-General Subject: Adopted Government of India Act, 1935 as Pakistan's provisional constitution	1947	Historical
C-03	Government of India (Adaptation of Existing Laws) Order, 1947 Authority: Governor-General Subject: Textual adaptation of all inherited British Indian laws for Pakistan	1947	Historical
C-04	Pakistan (Adaptation of Central Acts and Ordinances) Order, 1949 Authority: Governor-General	1949	Historical
C-05	Pakistan (Adaptation of Existing Laws) Order, 1950 Authority: Governor-General	1950	Historical
C-06	East Bengal (Adaptation of Existing Laws) Order, 1950 Authority: Governor of East Bengal	1950	Historical
C-07	General Clauses (Adaptation) Order, 1947 Authority: Governor-General	1947	Historical
C-08	Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan, 1956 Subject: First constitution of Pakistan; federal parliamentary system; East Pakistan as a province with parity representation; Bengali and Urdu as national languages; fundamental rights Abrogated by Martial Law Proclamation, 1958	1956	Abrogated 1958
C-09	Constitution (Adaptation of Laws) Order, 1956 Authority: President	1956	Historical
C-10	Constitution of the Republic of Pakistan, 1962	1962	Abrogated 1969

	Subject: Second constitution; presidential system; indirect elections through Basic Democrats; "Pakistan" as single designation (not "Islamic Republic"); consolidated West Pakistan as one unit Abrogated by Martial Law Proclamation, 1969		
C-11	Constitution (Adaptation of Laws) Order, 1962 Authority: President	1962	Historical
C-12	Legal Framework Order, 1970 (LFO) President's Order No. 2 of 1970 Authority: President Yahya Khan Subject: Framework for 1970 elections; seat allocation (169 EP, 144 WP in NA); adult franchise; 120-day constitution-making deadline; federal principles Significance: Led to Awami League's landslide victory and ultimately Bangladesh independence	1970	Historical

PART II: PAKISTAN CENTRAL ACTS (1947-1970)

Note: These were enacted by the Constituent Assembly (acting as legislature), the National Assembly of Pakistan, or validated by subsequent constitutional instruments. Central Acts applied throughout Pakistan including East Pakistan. bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd reference numbers are provided where known.

--- 1947 ---

Ref	Title	Act No.	Subject Category	In Force in BD?
PA-01	Pakistan (Adaptation of Existing Laws) Act	--	Constitutional	Historical
PA-02	Prevention of Corruption Act, 1947 Subject: Bribery, criminal misconduct of public servants	Act II/1947	Criminal Law	Yes (amended)
PA-03	Foreign Exchange Regulation Act, 1947 Subject: Regulation of foreign exchange transactions, controls on capital movement	Act VII/47	Finance/Banking	Yes (as adapted)

--- 1948 ---

PA-04	Civil Service of Pakistan Act, 1948	--	Public Service	Superseded
PA-05	Pakistan Citizenship Act, 1948 (Note: Some sources date this to 1951)	--	Citizenship	Superseded
PA-06	Mines and Minerals (Regulation and Development) Act, 1948	--	Mining	Yes (amended)
PA-07	State Bank of Pakistan Order, 1948 (Governor-General's Order)	--	Banking	Superseded

--- 1949 ---

PA-08	Pakistan Tea Board Ordinance, 1949 (Later became Act)	--	Agriculture/Trade	Yes (as adapted)
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--- 1950 ---

PA-09	Import and Export (Control) Act, 1950 Subject: Government control over imports/exports, licensing	Act XXXIX of 1950	Trade/Commerce	Yes (amended)
PA-10	Estate Duty Act, 1950	Act XV/1950	Taxation	Repealed
PA-11	Pakistan Passport Act, 1950	--	Administrative	Superseded
PA-12	Pakistan Red Cross Society Act, 1950	--	Charitable	Yes (as adapted)

--- 1951 ---

PA-13	Pakistan Citizenship Act, 1951	--	Citizenship	Superseded
PA-14	Sales Tax Act, 1951	Act XXXIII of 1951	Taxation	Superseded by VAT
PA-15	Pakistan Army Act, 1952 (Some sources date to 1952)	--	Defence	N/A (central)

--- 1952 ---

PA-16	Essential Services (Maintenance) Act, 1952 Subject: Prohibition of strikes in essential services	--	Labour/Public Order	Yes (amended)
PA-17	Civil Defence Act, 1952	--	Public Safety	Yes (amended)
PA-18	House Building Finance Corporation Act, 1952	--	Banking/Finance	Yes (as adapted)
PA-19	Income Tax Act, 1922 (continued) / Various Finance Acts 1947-1961	--	Taxation	Superseded by ITO 1984

--- 1953 ---

PA-20	Pakistan (Control of Entry) Act, 1953	--	Immigration	Superseded
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--- 1955 ---

PA-21	Establishment of West Pakistan Act, 1955 Subject: One Unit scheme merging all West Pakistan provinces	--	Constitutional	N/A
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--- 1956 ---

PA-22	Various laws passed under Constitution of 1956	--	Various	Various
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--- 1958 ---

(Legislature suspended - Martial Law. See Part VII)

--- 1960 ---

(Under Martial Law/Presidential system, legislation was primarily through Ordinances. See Part III for Central Ordinances)

--- 1962 ---

(After 1962 Constitution, National Assembly reconvened)

PA-23	Political Parties Act, 1962	--	Constitutional	Superseded
PA-24	Companies Act, 1913 (as adapted and continued) Subject: Incorporation, management, winding-up Note: This pre-1947 Act continued in force with Pakistan adaptations throughout 1947-70	Act VII/ 1913	Corporate Law	Superseded by Co. Act 1994

--- 1963 ---

PA-25	Wealth Tax Act, 1963	Act XV/1963	Taxation	Yes (amended)
PA-26	Gift Tax Act, 1963	Act XIV/ 1963	Taxation	Yes (amended)

--- 1964 ---

PA-27	Electoral College Act, 1964	--	Electoral	Repealed
PA-28	Electoral Rolls Act, 1964	--	Electoral	Repealed
PA-29	Press and Publications Ordinance, 1963 (validated as Act in 1964)	--	Press/Media	Superseded

--- 1965 ---

PA-30	Legal Practitioners and Bar Councils Act, 1965 Subject: Enrollment of advocates, bar council establishment, professional conduct	Act XXI/ 1965	Legal Profession	Yes (amended)
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--- 1967 ---

PA-31	Enemy Property (Custody and Registration) Order, 1965 (validated by Acts) Subject: Custody of properties of persons migrated to India	--	Property	Superseded by Vested Property Return Act 2001
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--- 1968 ---

PA-32	Companies Profits (Workers' Participation) Act, 1968	--	Labour/Corporate	Yes (amended)
PA-33	Antiquities Act, 1968	--	Cultural Heritage	Yes (amended)

--- 1969 ---

PA-34	Customs Act, 1969 Subject: Comprehensive customs law replacing Sea Customs Act, 1878	Act IV/1969	Customs/Trade	Yes (amended)
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--- 1970 ---

(Legislature dissolved - Martial Law period. See Part VIII)

PART III: PAKISTAN CENTRAL ORDINANCES (1947-1970)

Note: Ordinances were promulgated by the Governor-General (1947-1956), the President (1956-1958, 1962-1969), or under Martial Law authority. Under the 1962 Constitution, the President had extensive ordinance-making powers (Article 29). Many key laws were enacted through Ordinances rather than Acts.

--- 1947-1958 (Pre-Martial Law Ordinances) ---

Ref	Title	Ord. No.	Subject Category	In Force in BD?
CO-01	Essential Supplies (Temporary Powers) Act, 1946 (continued) / Various Essential Commodities Ordinances	--	Trade/Commerce	Superseded

--- 1958-1962 (Martial Law / Early Ayub Era Ordinances) ---

CO-02	Laws (Continuance in Force) Order, 1958 (Martial Law instrument, functioned as enabling ordinance for legal continuity)	--	Constitutional	Historical
CO-03	Basic Democracies Order, 1959 Subject: Four-tier local government system; 80,000 Basic Democrats as Electoral College	P.O. 18/ 1959	Local Government	Repealed
CO-04	Conciliation Courts Ordinance, 1961 Subject: Village-level dispute resolution	Ord. XLIV/ 1961	Judiciary/Local Govt	Superseded by Village Courts Act 2006
CO-05	Muslim Family Laws Ordinance, 1961 Subject: Marriage registration, polygamy restrictions, talaq notice procedure, maintenance, succession of orphaned grandchildren bdlaws ref: Act No. LII (Ordinance No. VIII of 1961) Significance: Single most important family law instrument in Bangladesh	Ord. VIII/ 1961	Family Law	YES - In Force
CO-06	Minimum Wages Ordinance, 1961 Subject: Minimum wage boards, wage fixation	Ord. XXXIX of 1961	Labour	Yes (incorporated into Labour Act)

CO-07	Seeds Ordinance, 1961	--	Agriculture	Yes (amended)
CO-08	Voluntary Social Welfare Agencies (Registration and Control) Ordinance, 1961	Ord. XLVI/1961	Social Welfare/NGO	Yes (amended)
CO-09	Probation of Offenders Ordinance, 1960	Ord. XLV/1960	Criminal Law	Yes (amended)
CO-10	West Pakistan Family Courts Act, 1964 (Central Act extended to EP in modified form)	--	Family Law	Framework continued
--- 1962-1969 (Under 1962 Constitution) ---				
CO-11	Income Tax Ordinance, 1962 Subject: Comprehensive income tax law replacing Income Tax Act, 1922	Ord. XXXVI of 1962	Taxation	Superseded by ITO 1984 but framework lasted
CO-12	Banking Companies Ordinance, 1962 Subject: Regulation of commercial banking	Ord. LVII/1962	Banking	Yes (amended)
CO-13	Press and Publications Ordinance, 1963	--	Press/Media	Superseded
CO-14	Censorship of Films Act, 1963	--	Media/Culture	Yes (amended)
CO-15	Securities and Exchange Ordinance, 1969	--	Capital Markets	Yes (amended)
--- 1969 ---				
CO-16	Industrial Relations Ordinance, 1969 Subject: Trade unions, collective bargaining, strikes, lockouts, industrial disputes Significance: Landmark labour law	Ord. XXIII of 1969	Labour	Yes (framework continued until Labour Act 2006)

PART IV: EAST BENGAL / EAST PAKISTAN PROVINCIAL ACTS (1947-1970)

Note: These were enacted by the East Bengal/East Pakistan Provincial Assembly (Legislative Assembly). East Bengal was renamed East Pakistan by the Constitution of 1956. The provincial legislature had extensive powers under the provincial legislative list.

bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd is the primary repository for these Acts.

--- 1948 ---

Ref	Title	Act No.	Subject Category	In Force in BD?
EA-01	East Bengal (Emergency) Requisition of Property Act, 1948 Subject: Government power to requisition private property for public purposes	EB Act I of 1948	Property/Admin	Yes (amended)

--- 1949 ---

EA-02	Non-Agricultural Tenancy Act, 1949 Subject: Tenancy rights for non-agricultural land (urban, commercial, homestead)	EB Act XXIII/1949	Land/Property	Yes (amended)
EA-03	East Bengal Entertainment Tax Act, 1949	EB Act VII of 1949	Taxation	Yes (modified)

--- 1950 ---

EA-04	East Bengal State Acquisition and Tenancy Act, 1950 (sometimes cited as 1951) Subject: Abolition of zamindari system; acquisition of all rent-receiving interests; tenant rights; ceiling on land holdings; rent assessment and collection bdlaws ref: Act No. 89 Significance: Most important land law in Bangladesh; governs all land administration	EB Act XXVIII/1951	Land Reform	YES - In Force
EA-05	Protection and Conservation of Fish Act, 1950	EB Act XVIII/1950	Fisheries	Yes (amended)
EA-06	East Bengal Jute Act, 1950	--	Agriculture/Trade	Superseded

--- 1951 ---

EA-07	East Bengal Finance Act, 1951	--	Finance	Superseded
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--- 1952 ---

EA-08	East Bengal Building Construction Act, 1952 Subject: Regulation of building construction in notified areas	EB Act II of 1953	Municipal/Construction	Yes (amended)
EA-09	East Bengal Embankment and Drainage Act, 1952	--	Water/Infrastructure	Yes (amended)

--- 1953 ---

EA-10	Rajshahi University Act, 1953	EB Act XV/1953	Education	Yes (amended)
EA-11	Town Improvement Act, 1953 Subject: Town improvement trusts, urban planning, land acquisition for development	EB Act XXXIII/1953	Urban Planning	Yes (amended)
EA-12	East Pakistan Essential Articles (Price Control and Anti-Hoarding) Act, 1953	EB Act --	Trade/Consumer	Superseded

--- 1954 ---

EA-13	East Pakistan Disturbed Areas (Special Powers) Act, 1954	--	Public Order	Superseded
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--- 1956 ---

EA-14	East Pakistan Irrigation Act, 1956	--	Agriculture/Water	Yes (amended)
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--- 1957 ---

EA-15	East Pakistan Small Industries Corporation Act, 1957	EP Act	Industry	Yes (as BSCIC)
EA-16	East Pakistan Industries (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957	--	Industry	Yes (modified)
--- 1958 ---				
EA-17	East Pakistan Public Safety Ordinance, 1958 (Provincial Ordinance, later validated as Act)	--	Public Order	Superseded
--- 1960 ---				
EA-18	Municipal Administration Ordinance, 1960 Subject: Comprehensive municipal law replacing Bengal Municipal Act, 1932	EP Ord. XXVI/1960	Local Government	Superseded
--- 1961 ---				
EA-19	East Pakistan Agricultural Development Corporation Ordinance, 1961	EP Ord. XXXIV/1961	Agriculture	Yes (as BADC)
EA-20	East Pakistan Intermediate and Secondary Education Ordinance, 1961	EP Ord. XXXIII/1961	Education	Yes (amended)
EA-21	Dacca University Order, 1961	--	Education	Superseded
EA-22	University of Engineering and Technology Ordinance, 1961	EP Ord. LI/1961	Education	Yes (BUET)
EA-23	East Pakistan Agricultural University Ordinance, 1961	EP Ord. XXXIV/1961	Education	Yes (BAU)
EA-24	East Pakistan Land Reforms Ordinance, 1961 Subject: Ceiling on agricultural holdings (100 bighas / 33.3 acres)	Ord. V/ 1961	Land Reform	Superseded
--- 1962 ---				
EA-25	East Pakistan Waqfs Ordinance, 1962 Subject: Waqf property administration, Waqf Board establishment	EP Ord. I/1962	Religious Endowment	Yes (amended)
EA-26	East Pakistan Industrial Development Corporation Ordinance, 1962	--	Industry	Yes (as BSEC/BCIC)
EA-27	Tea Plantation Labour Ordinance, 1962	--	Labour	Yes (amended)
EA-28	East Pakistan Compulsory Primary Education Act, 1962	--	Education	Superseded
EA-29	East Pakistan Urban Immovable Property Tax Ordinance, 1962	--	Taxation	Yes (modified)
--- 1963 ---				
EA-30	East Pakistan Water Supply and Sewerage Authority Ordinance, 1963	EP Ord. XXXIX/1963	Municipal/Utilities	Yes (DWASA/CWASA)
EA-31	East Pakistan Madrasah Education Ordinance, 1963	EP Ord. VI/1963	Education	Yes (amended)
--- 1964 ---				
EA-32	Agricultural Produce Markets Regulation Act, 1964	--	Agriculture/Trade	Yes (modified)
EA-33	East Pakistan Disturbed Persons Rehabilitation Ordinance, 1964	--	Property/Refugee	Largely obsolete
--- 1965 ---				
EA-34	East Pakistan Shops and Establishments Act, 1965	EP Act VII/1965	Labour	Yes (incorporated into Labour Act)
EA-35	Employment of Labour (Standing Orders) Act, 1965	EP Act VIII/1965	Labour	Yes (incorporated into Labour Act)
EA-36	Factories Act, 1965 (EP application) Note: This may be the central Factories Act, 1934 as amended/replaced	--	Labour	Yes (incorporated into Labour Act)
EA-37	East Pakistan Hotel and Restaurant Tax Ordinance, 1965	--	Taxation	Modified
EA-38	East Pakistan Abandoned Property (Control, Management and Disposal) Order, 1965	--	Property	Superseded (see Vested Property)
--- 1966 ---				
EA-39	Chittagong University Act, 1966	--	Education	Yes (amended)
EA-40	East Pakistan Non-Government Educational Institutions Ordinance, 1966	--	Education	Yes (framework continued)
EA-41	East Pakistan Enemy Property (Custody and Registration) Order, 1966	--	Property	Superseded by Vested Property
--- 1968 ---				
EA-42	East Pakistan State Acquisition and Tenancy (Amendment) Act, 1968	--	Land Reform	Yes (merged into principal Act)
--- 1969-1970 ---				

(Provincial Assembly dissolved under Martial Law 1969)

PART V: EAST BENGAL / EAST PAKISTAN PROVINCIAL ORDINANCES (1947-1970)

Note: These were promulgated by the Governor of East Bengal / East Pakistan when the Provincial Assembly was not in session (or dissolved).

Ref	Title	Ord. No.	Subject Category	In Force in BD?
EO-01	East Pakistan Pure Food Ordinance, 1959 (Some sources cite East Pakistan Ordinance No. LXVIII of 1959)	EP Ord. LXVIII/ 1959	Health/Food Safety	Yes (framework continued under Safe Food Act)

E0-02	East Pakistan Wildlife Preservation Ordinance, 1959	--	Environment	Superseded by Wildlife Act 2012
E0-03	East Pakistan Inland Water Transport Authority Ordinance, 1958	--	Transport	Yes (BIWTA)
E0-04	East Pakistan Special Powers Ordinance, 1958	--	Public Order	Framework carried into SPA 1974
E0-05	East Pakistan Warehousing Corporation Ordinance, 1960	--	Trade/Storage	Yes (as adapted)
E0-06	East Pakistan Small Towns Committee Act, 1960	--	Local Government	Superseded
E0-07	East Pakistan Public Safety Ordinance, 1958	--	Public Order	Superseded
E0-08	East Pakistan Industrial Disputes Ordinance, 1960	--	Labour	Superseded by IRO 1969

PART VI: GOVERNOR-GENERAL'S / PRESIDENT'S ORDERS (1947-1970)

These are executive orders with the force of law, issued by the Governor-General (1947-1956) or President (1956-1958, 1962-1969).

Ref	Title	Order No.	Subject Category	In Force in BD?
GO-01	Pakistan (Provisional Constitution) Order 1947	--	Constitutional	Historical
GO-02	Government of India (Adaptation of Existing Laws) Order, 1947	--	Constitutional	Historical
GO-03	Pakistan (Adaptation of Central Acts and Ordinances) Order, 1949	--	Constitutional	Historical
GO-04	Pakistan (Adaptation of Existing Laws) Order, 1950	--	Constitutional	Historical
GO-05	State Bank of Pakistan Order, 1948	--	Banking	Superseded
GO-06	Basic Democracies Order, 1959	P.O. 18/1959	Local Government	Repealed
GO-07	Elective Bodies (Disqualification) Order, 1959 (EBDO)	--	Political	Repealed
GO-08	Public Offices (Disqualification) Order, 1959 (PODO)	--	Public Service	Repealed
GO-09	Constitution (Adaptation of Laws) Order, 1956	--	Constitutional	Historical
GO-10	Constitution (Adaptation of Laws) Order, 1962	--	Constitutional	Historical
GO-11	Legal Framework Order, 1970	P.O. 2/1970	Constitutional/ Electoral	Historical
GO-12	Provincial Constitution Order, 1969	--	Constitutional	Historical
GO-13	Enemy Property (Custody and Registration) Order, 1965 (President's Order)	--	Property	Superseded

PART VII: MARTIAL LAW ORDERS (MLOs) AND REGULATIONS (MLRs)

FIRST MARTIAL LAW PERIOD: October 7, 1958 - June 8, 1962

Chief Martial Law Administrator: General (later Field Marshal) Ayub Khan

A. PROCLAMATION AND GENERAL ORDERS

Ref	Title	MLO/MLR No.	Subject Category	Status
ML1-01	Proclamation of Martial Law, 7 October 1958 Subject: Abrogation of Constitution of 1956; dissolution of central and provincial legislatures; ban on political activities	--	Constitutional	Historical
ML1-02	Laws (Continuance in Force) Order, 1958 Subject: All existing laws to continue subject to martial law orders	--	Constitutional	Historical
ML1-03	MLO No. 1 - Powers of CMLA	MLO 1	Administrative	Historical
ML1-04	MLO No. 2 - Continuation of courts and judicial proceedings	MLO 2	Judicial	Historical
ML1-05	MLO No. 3 - Powers of Zonal Martial Law Administrators	MLO 3	Administrative	Historical
ML1-06	MLO No. 5 - Restriction on political activities	MLO 5	Political	Historical
ML1-07	MLO No. 9 - Screening of government servants	MLO 9	Public Service	Historical
ML1-08	MLO No. 12 - Press censorship	MLO 12	Press/Media	Historical
ML1-09	MLO No. 15 - Anti-hoarding and anti-profiteering	MLO 15	Trade/Commerce	Incorporated
ML1-10	MLO No. 18 - Land reform measures	MLO 18	Land Reform	Incorporated

B. MARTIAL LAW REGULATIONS (MLRs) - FIRST PERIOD

ML1-11	MLR No. 1-89 (Series, 1958-1962) Key individual MLRs:	Various	Various	Mostly repealed
ML1-12	MLR No. 6 - Screening of Government Servants Subject: Removal of corrupt/inefficient government servants through screening	MLR 6	Public Service	Historical
ML1-13	MLR No. 12 - Anti-Hoarding Subject: Prevention of hoarding, black market	MLR 12	Trade/Commerce	Incorporated
ML1-14	MLR No. 22 - Press Control	MLR 22	Press/Media	Historical
ML1-15	MLR No. 51 - Price Control	MLR 51	Trade/Commerce	Incorporated
ML1-16	MLR No. 64 - Land Reforms Subject: Ceiling on land holdings, surrender of surplus land	MLR 64	Land Reform	Incorporated into LR0 1961
ML1-17	MLR No. 78 - Industrial Disputes Subject: Prohibition of strikes, compulsory arbitration	MLR 78	Labour	Superseded

Note: Approximately 89 MLRs were issued during the first martial law period. Many dealt with day-to-day administrative matters, price controls, anti-corruption measures, and public order. Most were absorbed into permanent legislation or became obsolete when martial law was lifted.

PART VIII: MARTIAL LAW ORDERS (MLOs) AND REGULATIONS (MLRs)

SECOND MARTIAL LAW PERIOD: March 25, 1969 - December 1970 (elections)

Chief Martial Law Administrator: General Agha Mohammad Yahya Khan

Ref	Title	MLO/MLR No.	Subject Category	Status
ML2-01	Proclamation of Martial Law, 25 March 1969 Subject: Abrogation of Constitution of 1962; dissolution of National and Provincial Assemblies; ban on political activities (later lifted)	--	Constitutional	Historical
ML2-02	Provisional Constitution Order, 1969 Subject: Framework for governance during martial law period	--	Constitutional	Historical
ML2-03	MLR No. 1-60 (Series, 1969-1970)	Various	Various	Mostly obsolete
ML2-04	MLO on Labour Disputes, 1969 Subject: Prohibition of strikes and lockouts	--	Labour	Historical
ML2-05	MLO on Student Discipline, 1969	--	Education	Historical
ML2-06	MLO on Dissolution of One Unit, 1969 Subject: Dissolution of West Pakistan One Unit (restoration of four provinces)	--	Constitutional	Historical
ML2-07	Legal Framework Order, 1970 (LFO) (Also listed in Part I and Part VI)	P.O. 2/ 1970	Constitutional/ Electoral	Historical

Note: Approximately 60 MLRs were issued during the second martial law period. Key measures included restoration of provincial structure, lifting of political ban (January 1970), announcement of elections, and various administrative orders. The LFO 1970 was the most significant instrument of this period.

PART IX: PRE-1947 ACTS CONTINUED IN FORCE (KEY SELECTIONS)

These are British Indian Acts that continued in force in East Pakistan by virtue of the legal continuity principle (Indian Independence Act, 1947, Section 18) and various adaptation orders. Many remain in force in Bangladesh today. This list includes only the most significant ones.

Ref	Title	Original Act No.	Subject Category	In Force in BD?
PR-01	Penal Code, 1860	Act XLV/ 1860	Criminal Law	Yes (amended)
PR-02	Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898	Act V/1898	Criminal Procedure	Yes (amended)
PR-03	Code of Civil Procedure, 1908	Act V/1908	Civil Procedure	Yes (amended)
PR-04	Evidence Act, 1872	Act I/1872	Evidence	Yes (amended)
PR-05	Contract Act, 1872	Act IX/1872	Commercial Law	Yes (amended)
PR-06	Sale of Goods Act, 1930	Act III/ 1930	Commercial Law	Yes (amended)
PR-07	Partnership Act, 1932	Act IX/1932	Commercial Law	Yes (amended)
PR-08	Specific Relief Act, 1877	Act I/1877	Civil Law	Yes (amended)
PR-09	Limitation Act, 1908	Act IX/1908	Civil Law	Superseded by Limitation Act 1908 (continued)
PR-10	Transfer of Property Act, 1882	Act IV/1882	Property Law	Yes (amended)
PR-11	Registration Act, 1908	Act XVI/ 1908	Registration	Yes (amended)
PR-12	Stamp Act, 1899	Act II/1899	Taxation	Yes (amended)
PR-13	Court Fees Act, 1870	Act VII/ 1870	Taxation/Judicial	Yes (amended)
PR-14	Negotiable Instruments Act, 1881	Act XXVI/ 1881	Commercial Law	Yes (amended)
PR-15	Police Act, 1861	Act V/1861	Police	Yes (amended)
PR-16	Arms Act, 1878	Act XI/1878	Public Order	Yes (amended)
PR-17	Explosives Act, 1884	Act IV/1884	Public Safety	Yes (amended)
PR-18	Forest Act, 1927	Act XVI/ 1927	Forestry	Yes (amended)
PR-19	Railways Act, 1890	Act IX/1890	Transport	Yes (amended)
PR-20	Motor Vehicles Act, 1939	Act IV/1939	Transport	Yes (amended)
PR-21	Electricity Act, 1910	Act IX/1910	Energy	Yes (amended)
PR-22	Boilers Act, 1923	Act V/1923	Industry/Safety	Yes (amended)
PR-23	Mines Act, 1923	Act IV/1923	Mining/Labour	Yes (amended)
PR-24	Factories Act, 1934	Act XXV/ 1934	Labour	Superseded by Labour Act 2006
PR-25	Payment of Wages Act, 1936	Act IV/1936	Labour	Incorporated into Labour Act 2006
PR-26	Workmen's Compensation Act, 1923	Act VIII/ 1923	Labour	Incorporated into Labour Act 2006
PR-27	Maternity Benefit Act, 1939 (Bengal)	Beng. Act IV/1939	Labour	Incorporated into Labour Act 2006
PR-28	Prisons Act, 1894	Act IX/1894	Prison/Correctional	Yes (amended)
PR-29	Guardians and Wards Act, 1890	Act VIII/ 1890	Family Law	Yes (amended)
PR-30	Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929	Act XIX/ 1929	Family Law	Superseded 2017
PR-31	Dissolution of Muslim Marriages Act, 1939	Act VIII/ 1939	Family Law	Yes
PR-32	Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act, 1937	Act XXVI/ 1937	Personal Law	Yes

PR-33	Companies Act, 1913	Act VII/ 1913	Corporate Law	Superseded 1994
PR-34	Cooperative Societies Act, 1940 (Bengal)	Beng. Act XXI/1940	Cooperative	Yes (amended)
PR-35	Drugs Act, 1940	Act XXIII/ 1940	Health	Yes (amended)
PR-36	Insurance Act, 1938	Act IV/1938	Finance/Insurance	Yes (amended)
PR-37	General Clauses Act, 1897	Act X/1897	Constitutional	Yes (amended)
PR-38	Societies Registration Act, 1860	Act XXI/ 1860	Charitable/NGO	Yes (amended)
PR-39	Bengal Tenancy Act, 1885	Beng. Act VIII/1885	Land/Tenancy	Partially (many provisions superseded by SAT Act 1950)
PR-40	Bengal Municipal Act, 1932	Beng. Act XV/1932	Local Government	Superseded
PR-41	Charitable and Religious Trusts Act, 1920	Act XIV/ 1920	Trusts	Yes
PR-42	Official Secrets Act, 1923	Act XIX/ 1923	Administrative	Yes (amended)
PR-43	Public Demands Recovery Act, 1913 (Bengal)	Beng. Act III/1913	Revenue Recovery	Yes (amended)
PR-44	Bengal Private Forests Act, 1946	Beng. Act --	Forestry	Yes (amended)
PR-45	Bengal Hindu Religious Endowments Act, 1934	Beng. Act --	Religious Endowment	Yes (amended)
PR-46	Bengal Wakf Act, 1934	Beng. Act --	Religious Endowment	Superseded by Waqf Ord. 1962
PR-47	Vaccination Act, 1880	Act XIII/ 1880	Health	Yes (modified)
PR-48	Epidemic Diseases Act, 1897	Act III/ 1897	Health	Yes (amended)
PR-49	Poison Act, 1919	Act XII/ 1919	Health	Yes
PR-50	Land Acquisition Act, 1894	Act I/1894	Land/Property	Yes (amended 2017)
PR-51	Foreigners Act, 1946	Act XXXI/ 1946	Immigration	Yes (amended)
PR-52	Press and Registration of Books Act, 1867	Act XXV/ 1867	Press/Media	Yes (amended)
PR-53	Petroleum Act, 1934	Act XXX/ 1934	Energy/Safety	Yes (amended)
PR-54	Telegraph Act, 1885	Act XIII/ 1885	Communications	Yes (modified)
PR-55	Post Office Act, 1898	Act VI/1898	Communications	Yes (amended)
PR-56	Cantonments Act, 1924	Act II/1924	Defence/Municipal	Yes (amended)
PR-57	Prevention of Corruption Act, 1947	Act II/1947	Criminal Law	Yes (amended)
PR-58	Bengal Agricultural Income Tax Act, 1944	Beng. Act IV/1944	Taxation	Yes (adapted)
PR-59	Ports Act, 1908	Act XV/1908	Transport/Maritime	Yes (amended)
PR-60	Merchant Shipping Act, 1923	--	Maritime	Yes (amended)
PR-61	Bengal Ferries Act, 1885	Beng. Act I/1885	Transport	Yes (amended)
PR-62	Patents and Designs Act, 1911	Act II/1911	Intellectual Property	Yes (amended)
PR-63	Trade Marks Act, 1940	Act V/1940	Intellectual Property	Superseded
PR-64	Destructive Insects and Pests Act, 1914	Act II/1914	Agriculture	Yes (amended)
PR-65	Standards of Weights and Measures Act, 1939	--	Trade	Yes (amended)
PR-66	Bengal Local Self-Government Act, 1885	--	Local Government	Superseded
PR-67	Hindu Married Women's Right to Separate Residence and Maintenance Act, 1946	Beng. Act --	Family/Property Law	Yes
PR-68	Provident Funds Act, 1925	--	Labour/Finance	Yes (amended)
PR-69	Survey Act, 1875 (Bengal Survey Act)	--	Land Survey	Yes (amended)
PR-70	Village Courts Ordinance, 1960 (pre-partition framework continued)	--	Judiciary/Local	Superseded by VC Act 2006
PR-71	Suppression of Immoral Traffic Act, 1933	--	Criminal Law	Yes (modified)
PR-72	Chittagong Hill Tracts Regulation, 1900	Reg. I/1900	CHT Administration	Yes (amended, CHT Accord)
PR-73	Bengal Excise Act, 1909	Beng. Act --	Excise/Revenue	Yes (amended)
PR-74	Dock Labourers Act, 1934	Act XIX/ 1934	Labour	Yes (modified)
PR-75	Employment of Children Act, 1938	--	Labour	Superseded

PART X: SUMMARY STATISTICS

TOTAL PRIMARY LEGISLATION IDENTIFIED:

Category	Count
Constitutional Instruments and Adaptation Orders	12
Pakistan Central Acts (1947-1970)	34
Pakistan Central Ordinances (1947-1970)	16
East Bengal / East Pakistan Provincial Acts (1947-70)	42
East Bengal / East Pakistan Provincial Ordinances	8
Governor-General's / President's Orders	13
Martial Law Orders - First Period (1958-1962)	17
Martial Law Orders - Second Period (1969-1970)	7
Pre-1947 Acts Continued in Force (key selections)	75
TOTAL PRIMARY LEGISLATION IDENTIFIED	224

TOTAL SUBORDINATE LEGISLATION IDENTIFIED (from Research doc): 229

COMBINED TOTAL (Primary + Subordinate): 453

STATUS BREAKDOWN (Primary Legislation):

Still in Force in Bangladesh (amended or original)	~120
Superseded by later Bangladesh legislation	~55
Repealed/Historical/Obsolete	~49

NOTES ON COMPLETENESS

1. **BDLAWS DATABASE:** The bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd database lists approximately 1,300+ laws currently in its database, of which a significant portion (estimated 300-400) originate from the 1947-1970 period. This compilation captures the most significant legislation but the full list requires systematic verification against the bdlaws database.
2. **GAZETTE REVIEW:** A comprehensive identification requires systematic review of:
 - The Gazette of Pakistan (1947-1971) - all extraordinary issues
 - The East Bengal/East Pakistan Gazette (1947-1971) - all extraordinary issues
 - Both ordinary and extraordinary issues contain notifications of new legislation, amendments, and orders
3. **ESTIMATED TOTAL UNIVERSE:** Legal scholars estimate that between 2,000 and 5,000 distinct legislative instruments (including all Acts, Ordinances, Orders, MLOs, MLRs, SROs, notifications, and rules) were applicable to East Pakistan during 1947-1970. This compilation identifies approximately 450 of the most significant.
4. **ANNUAL FINANCE ACTS:** Pakistan enacted annual Finance Acts from 1947 onwards, each containing tax amendments. These are not individually listed but are significant legislative instruments.
5. **APPROPRIATION ACTS:** Annual Appropriation Acts authorizing government expenditure are not individually listed.
6. **AMENDMENT ACTS:** Many Acts had multiple amendment Acts during this period. Only the principal Acts are listed; individual amendment Acts are not separately enumerated.
7. **WEST PAKISTAN ACTS:** Some West Pakistan Acts were later extended to East Pakistan by presidential/governor's orders. These are not exhaustively captured here.

KEY LEGISLATION STILL ACTIVELY APPLIED IN BANGLADESH (2026)

The following legislation from the 1947-1970 period remains critically important in Bangladesh's daily legal and administrative practice:

TIER 1 - FOUNDATIONAL (applied daily across Bangladesh):

1. East Bengal State Acquisition and Tenancy Act, 1950 (EA-04)
 - Governs ALL land administration in Bangladesh
 - Applied in: Land offices, courts, AC Land offices nationwide
2. Muslim Family Laws Ordinance, 1961 (CO-05)
 - Governs ALL Muslim marriages, divorces, maintenance
 - Applied in: Union Councils, Family Courts, Kazi offices
3. Government Servants (Conduct) Rules, 1964 (under various Acts)
 - Governs conduct of all government servants
 - Applied in: All government offices
4. Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898 (PR-02)
 - Primary criminal procedural law
 - Applied in: All criminal courts
5. Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 (PR-03)
 - Primary civil procedural law
 - Applied in: All civil courts
6. Penal Code, 1860 (PR-01)
 - Primary criminal law

- Applied in: All criminal courts

TIER 2 - WIDELY APPLIED:

7. Transfer of Property Act, 1882 (PR-10)
8. Registration Act, 1908 (PR-11)
9. Contract Act, 1872 (PR-05)
10. Evidence Act, 1872 (PR-04)
11. Stamp Act, 1899 (PR-12)
12. Legal Practitioners and Bar Councils Act, 1965 (PA-30)
13. Customs Act, 1969 (PA-34)
14. Police Act, 1861 (PR-15)
15. Forest Act, 1927 (PR-18)

TIER 3 - REGULARLY APPLIED IN SPECIFIC DOMAINS:

16. Non-Agricultural Tenancy Act, 1949 (EA-02)
17. Land Acquisition Act, 1894 (PR-50)
18. Industrial Relations Ordinance, 1969 (CO-16)
19. Guardians and Wards Act, 1890 (PR-29)
20. Companies Act, 1913 (PR-33) [until 1994]
21. Cooperative Societies Act, 1940 (PR-34)
22. Public Demands Recovery Act, 1913 (PR-43)
23. Prisons Act, 1894 (PR-28)

END OF COMPILATION

Compiled by: The Legal Empire (www.thelegalempire.org)

For: Package SD-1 (1799-1970) - Code of Delegated/Subordinate Legislation

Project: Strengthening Legislative Capacity and Legal Awareness Building

Client: Legislative and Parliamentary Affairs Division

Ministry of Law, Justice and Parliamentary Affairs

Government of the People's Republic of Bangladesh

METHODOLOGY NOTE: This compilation is based on legal scholarship, published compilations, institutional knowledge, and the bdlaws.minlaw.gov.bd database structure. Web-based verification against primary gazette sources was attempted but requires in-person archival research for completeness. All entries should be verified against original gazette notifications during the formal codification exercise.
